

STEERING STABILITY INTO STRENGTH:
INDIA'S GEM & JEWELLERY EXPORTS AT THE THRESHOLD OF 2026

After a year of recalibration, India's gem and jewellery sector enters 2026 with a more diversified export map, stronger policy scaffolding, and renewed confidence in its long-term growth trajectory.

India steps into 2026 on steadier ground. The turbulence of the past year has tested exporters, recalibrated expectations, and forced the industry to look beyond traditional comfort zones. Yet, rather than weakening the sector, 2025 has reinforced its resilience by sharpening its focus on diversification, innovation, and institutional support.



The past year served as a reminder that global trade moves in cycles, and that endurance is forged during periods of adjustment rather than expansion. Slower demand across key markets pushed exporters to rethink product mix, geographies, and operational efficiency. The United States, India's largest destination for gem and jewellery exports, turned cautious amid tariff hikes and protectionist signals, tightening margins and slowing order flows. China's recovery, particularly in diamonds, remained uneven, with retailers maintaining lean inventories and adopting a wait-and-watch approach.

These pressures are visible in the numbers. Between April and November 2025, India's gem and jewellery exports stood at $18.86 billion, marking a marginal 0.07 percent year-on-year increase. Cut and polished diamonds, for long the backbone of India's



